



ANAHAT MUSIC THERAPY TRAINING

English Batch Course Material

(*This document is own intellectual property of Anahat , It can be used to indicate that the information provided is only for informational & educational use, Sharing/transferring/publishing the data without permission is illegal)

Introduction of Indian Classical Music

Indian classical music has a long tradition. It is believed that music arrived from the Gandharva Veda of Samaveda. The roots of the classical music of India are found in the Vedic literature of Hinduism and the ancient Natyashastra, the classic Sanskrit text on performing arts by Bharata Muni.

Let us know some basic concepts in Indian classical music.

Music : Music is the combination of song, instrument and dance (By Bharatmooni)

Nada : An important element in music is sound. There are two main types of Nada.

1) Aahata 2) Anahata

Aahata Naad is created or to be played.

Anahata Naad is not created, it is originally there.

Notes(Swaras): It is a sound that is pleasant to hear and is continuous forever. The swaras are believed to have originated from Anahata Nada. Each note has such a different sound. There are a total of 7 main notes in music.

- Sa - Shadja
- Re - Rishabh
- Ga - Gandhar
- Ma - Madhyam
- Pa - Pancham
- Dha - Dhaiwat
- Ni - Nishad

Types:

There are three types of notes

- 1) **Achala swara** - These vowels do not change their position or remain fixed - **Sa, Pa**
- 2) **Komal Swara** - In some cases these notes change the location backwards from the root note - **Rishabh , Gandhar , Dhaiwat , Nishad**
- 3) **Tivra Swara** - In some cases these notes change the location from the root note to the next place - **Madhyam**

Saptak(Set): Set of 7 notes called saptak. There are 3 types of saptak

- 1) **Mandra Saptak** - A group of Lower notes.(Also known as Kharja)
- 2) **Madhya Saptak** - A group of middle notes.(Normal singing)
- 3) **Tar Saptak** - A group of Higher notes.(High pitch singing)

Scales : Set of the swaras played in different pitches with taking reference of specific notes as root notes called scale. Each note has its own scale. In Indian classical music , Sa is a root note and colour and number of the note labelled as scale name . for e.g. White 1 , Black 4 etc

Tala(Rhythm): A fixed time that brings sweetness and interest is called rhythm.Rhythm is very important in music to support melody/voice. In the rhythm, the specific words/sounds played in a repetitive manner and sometimes in variation as per requirement of the melody or voice. Each tala has a specific group of measures.

Sam - The first measure of each tala is called Sam.

Volume - the number of syllables in a rhythmic cycle

